Year 4 Admission Assessment

Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

These activities help us get to know you. Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

How to answer

Tick one box. Which one is an animal? a cat ☑ a cup ☐

Write your answer in the box. 5 + 4 = **9**

Show your working in the working box. 26 + 32 = **58**

Working

20 + 30 = 50 6 + 2 = 8 50 + 8 = 58

The parts of this paper

Part		Time
1	Listening	5 minutes
2	Reading	12 minutes
3	Writing	10 minutes
	Break	
4	Maths	18 minutes

Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

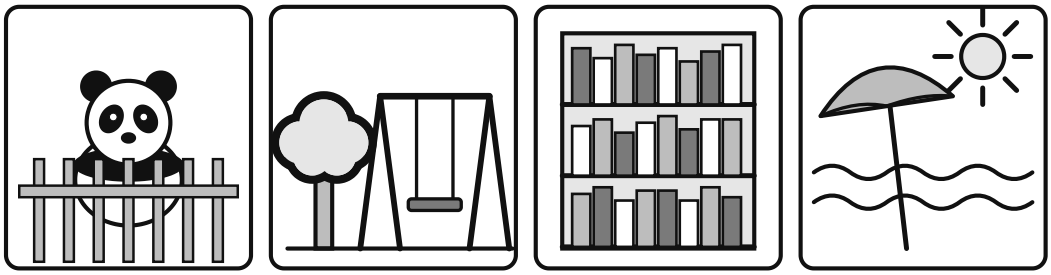
Part 1: Listening

Your teacher will read a phone call **two times**. Li Na is talking to her friend Amir.

Listen. Then answer the questions.

1 / 1

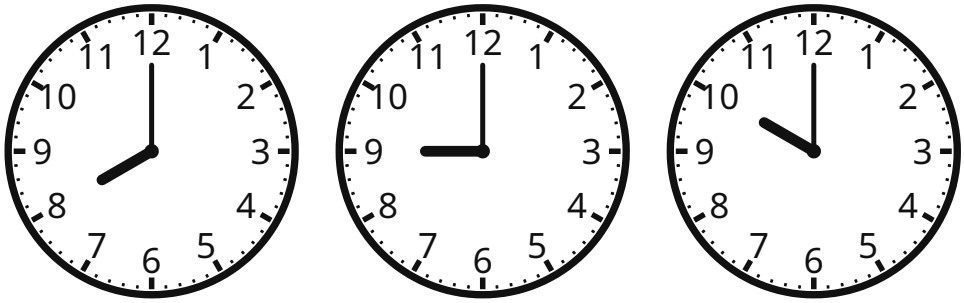
Where are they going on Saturday? **Tick** one picture.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐

2 / 1

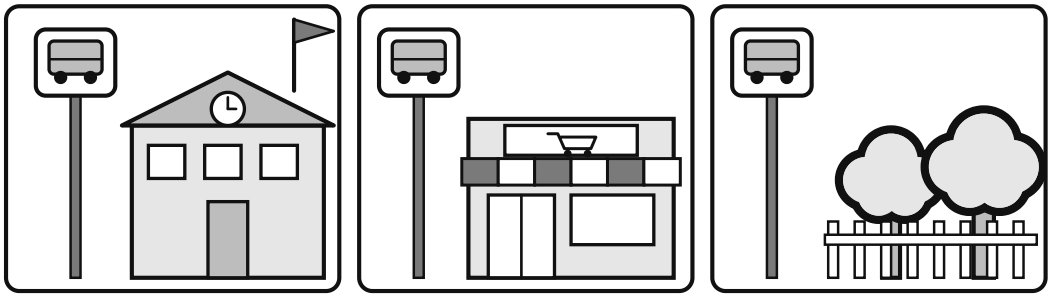
What time will they meet? **Tick** one clock.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

3 / 1

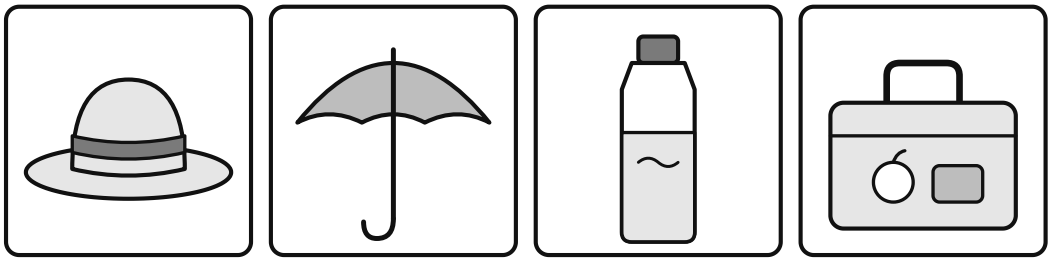
Where is the bus stop? **Tick** one picture.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

4 / 1

What must Amir bring? **Tick two** pictures.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐

5 / 1

What will Grandma make for lunch? **Write** one word.

6 / 1

How old is Amir's brother? **Write** a number.

7 / 1

Why does Amir's brother not need a ticket? **Write** your answer.

8 / 1

How does Amir feel about the trip? How do you know? **Write** your answer.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 2: Reading

Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.

There are three texts. **Read** each text. Then answer the questions.

Reading Part A

Read the menu. Then answer questions 1 to 7.



Happy Panda Café

Open Tuesday to Sunday, 11 am to 8 pm

Closed on Monday

Food		Drinks and sweets	
Noodles	**¥15**	Apple juice	**¥6**
Dumplings (10)	**¥12**	Milk	**¥4**
Fried rice	**¥14**	Ice cream	**¥5**

Water is free. Please ask.

1 / 1

What is the name of the café? **Write** it in the box.

2 / 1

How much are the dumplings? ¥

3 / 1

Mei buys the dumplings. How many dumplings does she get? ☐

4 / 1

Which drink costs ¥6? **Tick** one.

apple juice ☐ milk ☐ water ☐

5 / 1

What time does the café open? ☐

6 / 1

On which day is the café closed? ☐

7 / 2

Tick True or False.

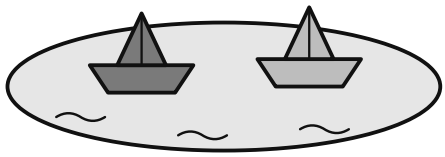
	True	**False**
You can buy ice cream at the café.	☐	☐
Water costs ¥2.	☐	☐

Reading Part B

Read the story. Then answer questions 8 to 14.

The Paper Boats

On Saturday, Wang Hao and Tom made paper boats. Wang Hao's boat was red. Tom's boat was blue.



They took the boats to the pond in the park. They put the boats on the water. The wind pushed them slowly across the pond.

Then the red boat got wet. It went down, down, down to the bottom. Wang Hao was sad.

"Don't worry," said Tom. "We can make a new one."

At home, they made a new red boat. This time, Wang Hao used thick paper and coloured it with wax crayons.

The next day, the new boat sailed all the way across the pond.

"It is the best boat in the world!" said Wang Hao.

8 / 1

What did Wang Hao and Tom make? **Tick** one.

paper hats ☐ paper boats ☐ paper kites ☐

9 / 1

What colour was Tom's boat? _____

10 / 1

Where did they take the boats? **Write** your answer.

_____

11

/ 2

Number the sentences 1 to 4 to show the order in the story. The first one is done for you.

The red boat went down to the bottom.	
Wang Hao and Tom made paper boats.	**1**
Wang Hao used thick paper.	
They put the boats on the water.	

12

/ 1

Find and **copy** one word that tells you how Wang Hao felt when his boat went down.

13

/ 1

Why did the first red boat go down to the bottom? **Write** your answer.

14

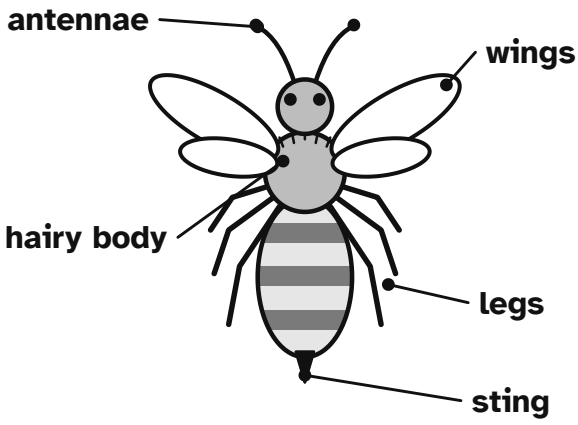
/ 1

Why did the new boat not go down? **Write** your answer.

Reading Part C

This text gives information. **Read** it. Then answer questions 15 to 22.

Honeybees: Busy Workers



Honeybees live together in a home called a hive. A big hive can hold more than fifty thousand bees! Each hive has one queen. She is the largest bee, and her job is to lay eggs. Most of the other bees are workers.

Busy workers

Worker bees have many jobs. Young workers clean the hive and feed the baby bees. Older workers fly out to find flowers. They drink a sweet juice called nectar and carry it back to the hive. There, they turn the nectar into honey and store it in tiny wax rooms called cells.

The waggle dance

When a worker finds good flowers, she flies home and does a special dance. She waggles her body from side to side and walks in a figure of eight. The dance tells the other bees which way to fly and how far to go.

Why we need bees

As bees move from flower to flower, yellow dust called pollen sticks to their hairy bodies. They carry it to other flowers. This helps plants to make seeds and fruit. Without bees, there would be fewer apples, strawberries and pumpkins.

Bees can sting, but they usually sting only when they are frightened. If a bee comes near you, keep still, and it will usually fly away.

15 / 1

What is the home of honeybees called? **Tick** one.

a nest ☐ a hive ☐ a cell ☐

16 / 1

What is the queen's job? **Write** your answer.

17 / 1

Which bees clean the hive and feed the baby bees? **Write** your answer.

18 / 1

"She waggles her body from side to side."

What does **waggles** mean? **Tick** one.

shakes ☐ sleeps ☐ sings ☐ eats ☐

19 / 1

Why does a worker bee do the waggle dance? **Write** your answer.

20 / 1

Why would there be fewer apples and strawberries without bees? **Write** your answer.

21 / 1

Why should you keep still if a bee comes near you? **Write** your answer.

22 / 1

Why do you think the writer put a diagram with this text? **Write** your answer.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 3: Writing

Choose one task. **Tick** the box for the task you choose.

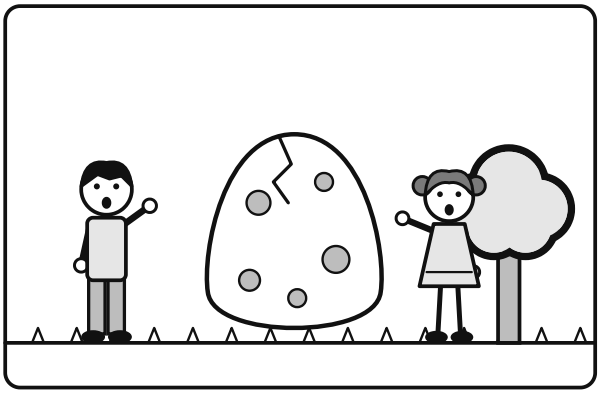
Task 1: The big egg ☐

Jun and Sofia find a very big egg in the park.

Write a story.

What is inside the egg?

What happens next?



Task 2: My favourite day of the year ☐

Write about your favourite day of the year.

When is it? What do you do? Who is with you? Why do you like it?

Plan your writing here. You can use words or pictures.

Plan

Write here.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 4: Maths

Section A: Number problems. Your teacher can read the questions to you. Do not use a calculator.

1 / 2

Example 20 + 5 = **25**

Write the answer in the box.

46 + 30 = ☐

92 – 8 = ☐

2 / 2

Write the answer in the box. **Show** your working.

356 + 218 = ☐

432 – 175 = ☐

Working

3 / 2

Write the answer in the box.

3 × 7 = ☐

4 × 8 = ☐

4 / 1

Write the answer in the box.

$56 \div 8 =$ ☐

5 / 1

Write the answer in the box. **Show** your working.

$23 \times 4 =$ ☐

Working

6 / 1

Write the answer in the box.

$\frac{1}{5} + \frac{2}{5} =$ ☐

7 / 1

Write the answer in the box. **Show** your working.

$124 \times 3 =$ ☐

Working

Maths: Section B

Word problems and pictures. Your teacher can read the questions to you.

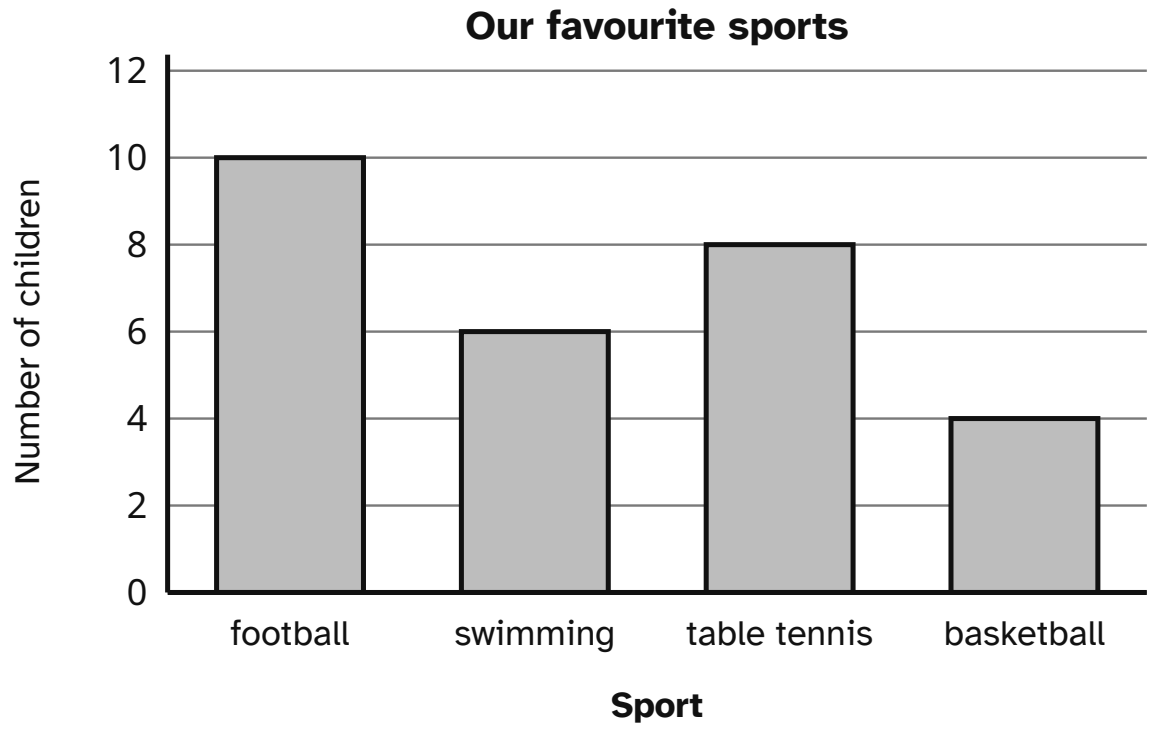
8 / 1

Write the number shown on the place value chart.

Hundreds	Tens	Ones
●●● ●		●●● ●●●

9 / 1

Look at the bar chart.



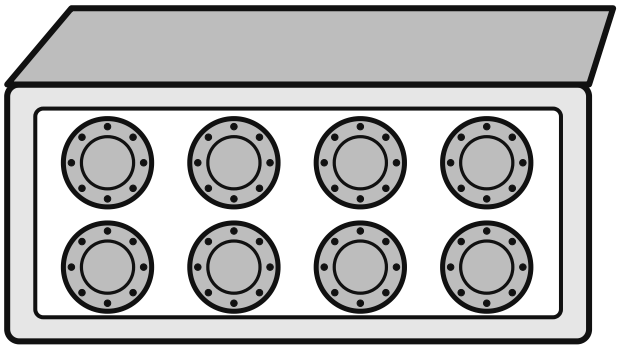
How many more children chose football than basketball?

10 / 1

One box has 8 mooncakes.

Mum buys 3 boxes.

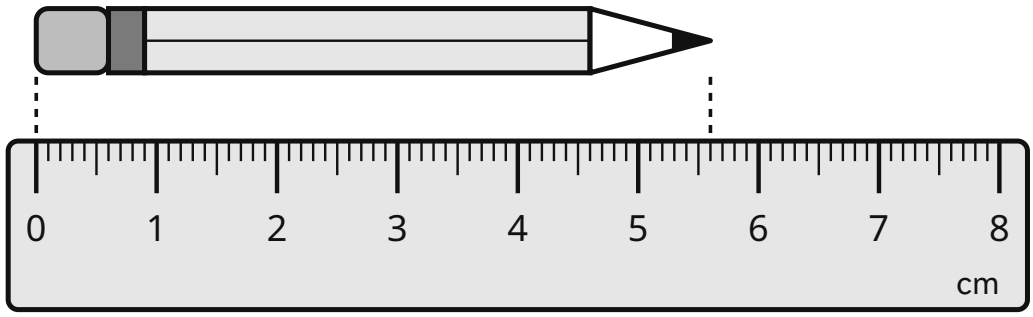
How many mooncakes does she buy?



[ ] mooncakes

11 / 1

How long is the pencil? Write your answer both in cm and mm.



[ ] cm [ ] mm

12

/ 1

A ribbon is 92 cm long.

Mei cuts off 35 cm.

How long is the ribbon now?



Not drawn accurately

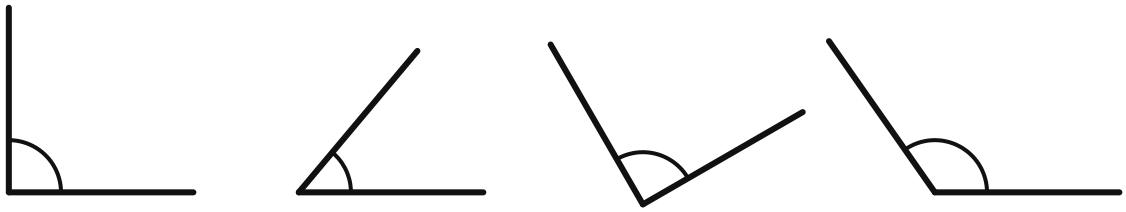
Working

cm

13

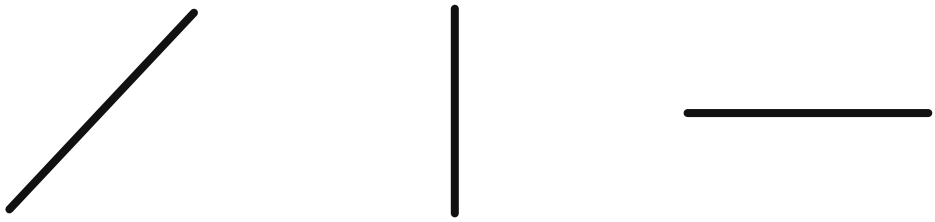
/ 2

a **Tick** each right angle.



A ☐ **B** ☐ **C** ☐ **D** ☐

b **Look** at lines E, F and G.

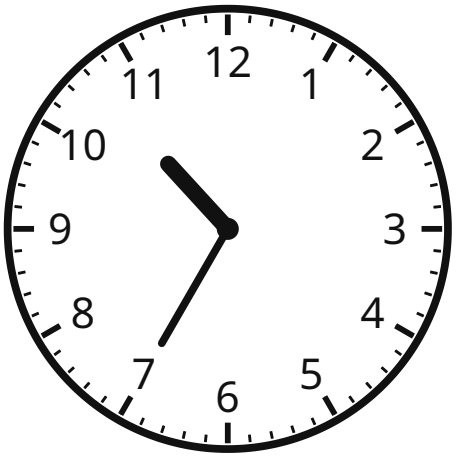


E **F** **G**

The horizontal line is ☐ The vertical line is ☐

14 / 2

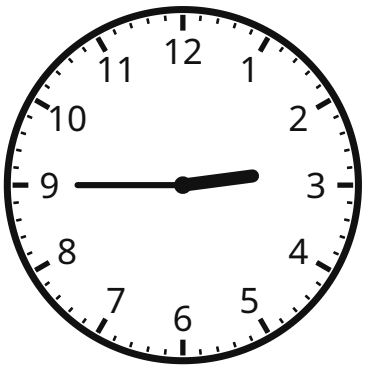
a **Write** the time in numbers, like a digital clock.



b A cartoon starts at 2:45. It ends at 3:20.

How many minutes long is the cartoon?

Starts



2:45

Ends



3:20

minutes

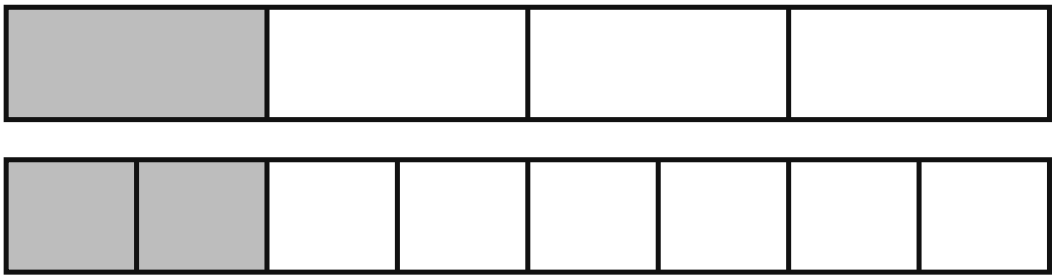
15

/ 2

a What fraction of the bar is shaded? **Write** it in the box.



b **Look** at the two bars. **Write** the missing number.

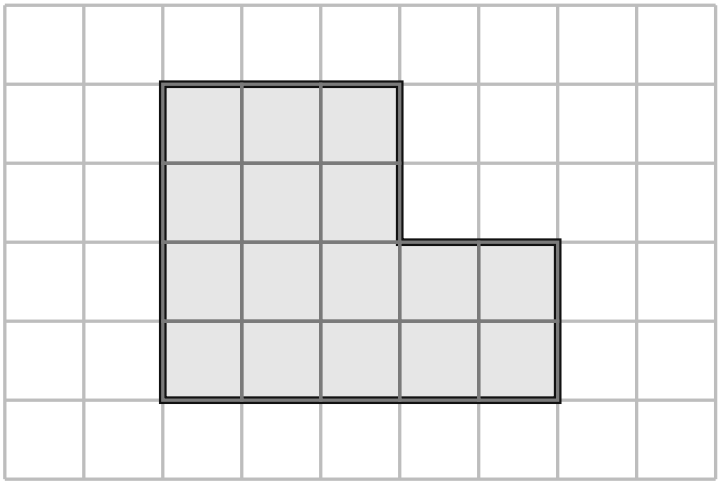


$$\frac{1}{4} = \frac{\square}{8}$$

16

/ 2

The shape is on a grid. Each square is 1 cm long.



a What is the **perimeter** of the shape?

cm

b What is the **area** of the shape?

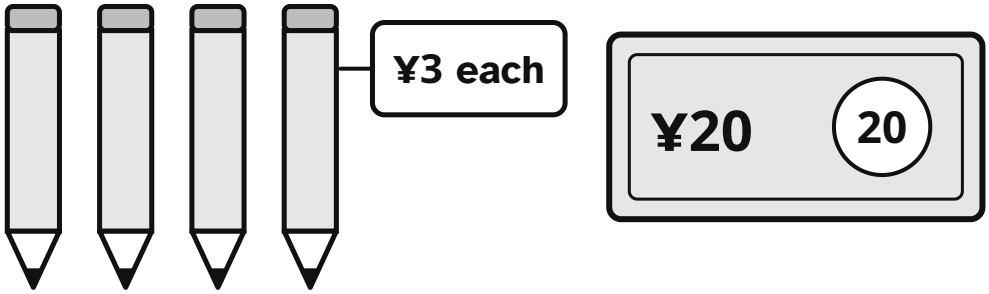
squares

17 / 2

Pencils cost ¥3 each.

Jun buys 4 pencils. He pays with a ¥20 note.

How much change does he get?



Working

¥

Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 4 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor booklet

Version 3.1, October 2026. Maths question 11 now says to write the length in cm and mm. Use with `Y04/Y04_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Who this is for. Students applying for Year 4 are usually 8 years old on 1 September. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 2** (二年级): numbers to 10 000, adding and subtracting, times tables to 9 × 9 and division facts, cm and m, g and kg, time to the minute, right angles and simple tables of data. Fractions, perimeter, area, millimetres and multiplying by a one-digit number usually come in Grade 3. English as a school subject often starts in Grade 3, so many students have only had English classes outside school; students from bilingual schools may be close to fluent.

How it works. About 57 minutes of student time, plus a welcome and a short break. The student writes in the **Student paper** (20 pages). Listening, reading, writing and maths can be taken in a small group with one invigilator (the listening is read to the group); the interview with sentence reading is always 1:1. Mark everything the same day and copy the score summary (Section 5) onto the Candidate Summary and Decision (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision.md`).

1. At a glance

	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student paper	You need
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	page 1	Section 2 of this booklet
2	Listening	5	Assessor reads the script; students answer	pages 2 to 3	Section 3.1 (the script)
3	Reading paper: Parts A, B and C	12	Students work alone	pages 4 to 10	A clock or timer
4	Writing	10	Students work alone	pages 11 to 12	
	Break	3 to 5			Water; a chance to move
5	Maths: Section A (number problems) and Section B (word problems and pictures)	18	Students work alone; you read any question on request	pages 13 to 20	Pencil, rubber, ruler marked in cm and mm
6	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start at Level 3)	12	Interviewer, 1:1		`forms/Interview_Record_Y3_Y4.md`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card.md`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`, a plain card

	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student paper	You need
	Total	**about 57**, plus welcome and break			

Print for each student: the Student paper (A4, single-sided, at actual size), this assessor booklet, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`, `forms/Interview_Record_Y3_Y4.md` and `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision.md`. **Reuse:** the laminated `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card.md`.

2. Before you start

The room. Quiet and bright, with space between desks. Each student has a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. Keep the door open or another adult present.

Say: "Hello, everyone. My name is [your name]. I am a teacher here. Today you will do some listening, reading, writing and maths, and then you will talk with a teacher. These activities help us get to know you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question."

Help each student write their name and the date on page 1. Point to the "How to answer" box and say: "This shows you how to answer. Tick a box like this. Write in a box like this. Show your working like this."

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English sections: listening, reading, writing, sentence reading	Maths
Reading aloud	Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or questions for the student. You may repeat an instruction in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Write **L** by the question. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.

Codes. NT not yet taught: the student says they have not learnt it; it scores 0 and is listed in the summary. **L** language support in maths. Record extra time, a reader or any other access arrangement for a known need in the score summary.

Stopping and keeping students at ease. Any student may stop a section when they have done what they can: they turn over and wait quietly. Praise effort, not answers. If a student is upset, give them a break or stop, and record it. Never press a distressed child. At the end of each timed part, let students finish the question they are on, then move on together.

3. English

3.1 Listening (5 minutes, student paper pages 2 to 3)

Say: "Turn to page 2, Part 1: Listening. You are going to hear a phone call. Li Na is talking to her friend Amir. I will read it two times. First, look at the questions with me."

Read the eight questions aloud, once, without the answer choices: "Question 1. Where are they going on Saturday? Question 2. What time will they meet? Question 3. Where is the bus stop? Question 4. What must Amir bring? Tick two pictures. Question 5. What will Grandma make for lunch? Question 6. How old is Amir's brother? Question 7. Why does Amir's brother not need a ticket? Question 8. How does Amir feel about the trip? How do you know?"

Say: "Now listen. You can answer while you listen, and after."

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace. Change your voice a little for the two speakers, but do not act. Do not stress the answers. Leave about 20 seconds between the two readings, and about 1 minute after the second reading for students to finish.

> **A phone call**
>
> **Li Na:** Hello, Amir. It's Li Na.
>
> **Amir:** Hi, Li Na!
>
> **Li Na:** Are you free on Saturday? My grandma is taking me to the zoo. Last time we went to the park, but this time we're going to the zoo. Can you come with us? [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Yes, please! I love the zoo. What time are you going?
>
> **Li Na:** Grandma wanted to go at eight o'clock, but that's very early. So we're going to meet at nine o'clock. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Nine o'clock. OK. Where?
>
> **Li Na:** At the bus stop. Not the bus stop near our school. The bus stop next to the supermarket. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** OK, next to the supermarket. What do I need to bring?
>
> **Li Na:** Bring a hat, because it will be sunny. You don't need an umbrella. And bring some water. Don't bring any lunch. Grandma is making dumplings for everyone. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Yum! I love dumplings. Can my little brother come too? He's five.
>
> **Li Na:** I'll ask Grandma. [pause] She says yes! Children under six don't need a ticket. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Brilliant! I can't wait. See you on Saturday!
>
> **Li Na:** Bye, Amir!

Answers (1 mark each)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	A (the zoo)		B (the park: they went last time)
2	B (9 o'clock)		A (8 o'clock: Grandma's first idea)
3	B (next to the supermarket)		A (near school)
4	A and C (hat and water)		Any other picture ticked, or only one ticked
5	dumplings	Any spelling that is clearly "dumplings": dumpling, damplins, dumplins	noodles; Chinese characters or pinyin (饺子, jiaozi): note it, as it shows understanding
6	5	five, fiv	6
7	He is five / under six, and children under six do not need a ticket.	"He is under six." "He is five." "Because he is small and children under six are free."	"He is small" or "he is a child" with no age; "Grandma pays"
8	A positive feeling **and** a reason from the call: "He is excited because he says 'Brilliant' / 'I can't wait' / 'I love the zoo' / 'Yes, please'."	happy, glad, pleased, can't wait, excited; the reason may be in the student's own words ("he wants to go a lot")	A feeling with no reason; a negative feeling
			Total / 8

Band guide: 0 to 2 **A**; 3 to 4 **B**; 5 to 6 **C**; 7 **D**; 8 **E**. Listening band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 3 each have a distractor that is also said (the park, eight o'clock, the school). Choosing the distractor means the student caught a familiar word but not "last time", "but" or "not": typical of band B.
- Questions 5 and 6 need one heard word. A clear but misspelt word still scores: it is a listening task.
- Questions 7 and 8 need the student to join two pieces of information or read Amir's feelings. Students who score these are following connected talk at a natural pace (bands D and E).

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, student paper pages 4 to 10)

Say: "Turn to page 4, Part 2: Reading. There are three texts: a menu, a story and a text about honeybees. Read each text and answer the questions. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Do not read any text or question aloud. Tell the students when there are 2 minutes left.

The three parts get harder. **Part A** is a menu with pictures. **Part B** is a short story written about two years below age level. **Part C** is **non-fiction** (an information text about honeybees, with a labelled diagram) at the level of a fluent 8 year old reader, and it is meant to stretch.

Answers (1 mark each unless stated). Spelling does not matter if the answer is clear, except where the question asks the student to copy a word.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
		Part A: the menu		
1	Retrieval	Happy Panda Café	Happy Panda Cafe; Happy Panda	Panda; Café
2	Retrieval	¥12	12	15, 14
3	Retrieval	10	ten	2 (counted the dumplings in the picture)
4	Retrieval	apple juice		
5	Retrieval	11 am	11, 11 o'clock, eleven, 11:00	8 pm
6	Retrieval	Monday	Mon	Tuesday; Sunday
7	Retrieval and simple inference (2 marks)	Ice cream: **True**. Water costs ¥2: **False**	1 mark for each correct row	
		Part B: The Paper Boats		
8	Retrieval	paper boats		
9	Retrieval	blue		red (Wang Hao's boat)
10	Retrieval	to the pond in the park	"the pond"; "the park"; "a pond"	"home"; "the sea"; "on the water" with no place
11	Sequencing (2 marks)	Went down: **3**. Made boats: 1 (given). Thick paper: **4**. Put on the water: **2**	2 marks for all three correct; 1 mark if two neighbouring events are swapped	
12	Vocabulary (find and copy)	sad		worry (Tom's word); happy
13	Simple inference	It got wet (the paper got wet).	"The paper was wet." "Paper and water." "The paper was thin."	"It was old." "The wind."
14	Simple inference	Wang Hao used thick paper and coloured it with wax crayons.	Either idea: "thick paper" or "wax crayons"; "the paper was strong"	"It was red." "Tom helped."
		Part C: Honeybees: Busy Workers (non-fiction)		

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
15	Retrieval	a hive		a cell (the tiny wax rooms); a nest
16	Retrieval	to lay eggs	"lay eggs"; "make eggs"	"she is the biggest"; "make honey"
17	Retrieval	young workers	young bees; the young (worker) bees	the queen; older workers
18	Vocabulary in context	shakes		
19	Retrieval and inference	To tell the other bees which way to fly and how far to go (where the flowers are).	"To show where the flowers are." "To tell them the way."	"Because she is happy." "To have fun."
20	Inference	Bees carry pollen from flower to flower, and this helps plants make fruit.	"Bees help the plants make fruit." "No bees to carry pollen."	"Bees eat the apples." "Apples need honey."
21	Inference	So the bee is not frightened and does not sting you; it will fly away.	"So it does not sting you." "Bees sting when they are scared." "It will fly away."	"Because bees are bad." "To catch it."
22	Author's purpose (why do you think)	To show the parts of a bee / what a bee looks like / to help the reader understand the words.	"So we can see the wings, legs and sting." "To help you understand."	"Because it is nice." "To colour it."

Part A (Questions 1 to 7)	Part B (Questions 8 to 14)	Part C (Questions 15 to 22)	Total
/ 8	/ 8	/ 8	**/ 24**

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B**
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C**
Part C 3 to 5	**D**
Part C 6 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example a high Part C score with a low Part B score usually means the student rushed or ran out of time), and check against the sentence reading screen. Reading band: **A B C D E**

What to look for

- **Strong readers** finish Part C, answer in their own words and give reasons ("because ...").
- **Decoding ahead of understanding:** a good sentence reading score but weak Part B and Part C answers, or answers copied from the wrong place in the text. Common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet outside school.
- **An English barrier, not a reading difficulty:** correct answers that are hard to read ("so it not scard and sting") still score.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, student paper pages 11 to 12)

Say: "Turn to page 11, Part 3: Writing. There are two tasks. Choose one task and tick the box. Task 1 is a story about a big egg. Task 2 is about your favourite day of the year. Use the plan box first if you want to. Then write on page 12. You have 10 minutes." You may read the two task boxes aloud once. Do not give words, spellings or ideas.

The two tasks

- **Task 1: The big egg** (story, with a picture). "Jun and Sofia find a very big egg in the park. Write a story. What is inside the egg? What happens next?"
- **Task 2: My favourite day of the year** (my favourite). "Write about your favourite day of the year. When is it? What do you do? Who is with you? Why do you like it?"

The four criteria. Score each from 0 to 4; 1 and 3 fall between the descriptions.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	No English writing on the task, or only copied words.	A few connected sentences on the task, with a simple order (a beginning and an end, or a short list of things they do).	A complete piece that suits the task: a story with a beginning, an event or problem and an ending, or a description with several points and reasons. Ideas grouped in paragraphs or clear sections.
Vocabulary	No English words of the student's own.	Everyday words, often repeated (nice, good, big, go, play).	Varied, precise words for the age (cracked, peeped, wobbled, delicious, lanterns, excited) and some longer noun phrases ("a huge spotted egg").
Grammar and sentences	No sentence.	Simple sentences with frequent errors in tense, plurals and "a" and "the"; ideas joined mostly with "and" and "then".	Mostly accurate sentences, a range of joining words (because, when, so, but, if, after), tense kept the same, some variety (a question, some speech).
Spelling and punctuation	Very few words can be read.	Common words mostly right; other words spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops some of the time.	Most words right, including common Year 2 and Year 3 words; capital letters, full stops, question marks and commas in lists used correctly; perhaps speech marks or apostrophes.

Task chosen	Content and organisation	Vocabulary	Grammar and sentences	Spelling and punctuation	Total
1 2	/ 4	/ 4	/ 4	/ 4	**/ 16**

Writing band (best fit). Read the piece against the band descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and choose the band that fits best, not the total alone. As a rough guide: about 0 to 3 **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**. Writing band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

What band E looks like at this age. In 10 minutes, about 10 to 14 lines or more: a story with a clear beginning, middle and end, or an organised description with reasons; sentences joined with because, when, so and if; the tense kept the same; some well-chosen words and longer phrases; common words spelt correctly; capital letters, full stops and question marks used correctly, perhaps with speech marks. This is what a fluent English-speaking child at the end of UK Year 3 writes.

What to look for

- Missing past tense and plural endings and missing "a" and "the" are normal for a learner of English. Judge how much the student can communicate and organise.
- A long, well-organised piece with many grammar errors (band C or D) shows a student who will make fast progress with support; a short, accurate piece may show a cautious writer: compare with the interview.
- Task 2 is easier to write from memory; Task 1 needs imagination. Note which task was chosen.

3.4 Interview with sentence reading (12 minutes, 1:1)

Use `forms/Interview_Record_Y3_Y4.md`. The interview opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen** (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card.md` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`): **start at Level 3** (sentence 7) and follow the start, going back and stopping rules on the record (about 3 to 4 minutes). Then hold the interview: choose about two questions from each block, and give the **speaking band** on the form. The interview also gives a "listening in conversation" band: compare it with the listening task. To finish, thank the student and tell them one thing they did well. Do not give any results.

4. Maths (18 minutes, student paper pages 13 to 20)

Say: "Turn to page 13, Part 4: Maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and problems with pictures. I can read any question to you. Just put your hand up. You have 18 minutes. Do not use a calculator."

- **Equipment:** pencil, rubber, ruler. No calculator.
- **Reading aloud:** read any question in English as often as the student asks, and point to the picture. The word problems are Questions 10, 12, 14b and 17. In a group, go to the student and read quietly. The Chinese reading is once only, by a colleague, after the English: write **L**.
- **Time:** about 6 minutes for Section A and 12 for Section B. Tell the students when there are 5 minutes left. If a student says they have not learnt something, write **NT**.
- Questions 7 and 16b are Year 4 content, there to find the ceiling. A Year 4 entrant is not expected to get them.

Mark scheme. One mark for each answer unless the table says otherwise. Type: **N** number problem, **W** word problem, **P** problem with a picture, chart or diagram.

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Mark
		Section A: Number problems			
1	N	76; 84		Floor questions (UK Year 2 work).	/ 2
2	N	574; 257		564 (did not carry). 343 for the second (took the smaller digit from the larger in each column). Column subtraction with two exchanges may not have been taught (Chinese Grade 3).	/ 2
3	N	21; 32		Usually strong: times tables to 9 × 9 are Grade 2 work.	/ 2
4	N	7			/ 1
5	N	92		812 (8 and 12 written side by side) or 82 (forgot to carry). Multiplying a two-digit number may not have been taught (Grade 3); a student may still use 23 + 23 + 23 + 23.	/ 1
6	N	$^{3}/_{5}$	three fifths; 五分之三 (write L)	$^{3}/_{10}$ (added the bottom numbers too). Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	/ 1
7	N	372		Year 4 content. May not have been taught (Grade 3).	/ 1
		Section B: Word problems and pictures			
8	P	406		46 (no zero for the empty tens column): place value not secure.	/ 1
9	P	6		14 (added 10 and 4). 4 or 10 (read one bar only).	/ 1
10	W	24	24 mooncakes	11 (added 8 and 3) suggests the question was not understood: read it again.	/ 1
11	P	5 cm 6 mm	56 mm written in the mm box; 5.6 cm; 5.6 cm and 56 mm (both ways)	5 cm 5 mm or 5 cm 7 mm. Millimetres may not have been taught (Grade 3).	/ 1
12	W	57 cm	57	127 (added). 63 (took the smaller digit from the larger: 5 – 2). 67 (exchanged a ten but did not take it from the tens).	/ 1
13	P	a A and C; b horizontal G, vertical F		a: both A and C, and nothing else, for the mark. Students who tick only A have not recognised a turned right angle. b: both letters for the mark. The words "horizontal" and "vertical" may be new in English: read them, but do not explain them.	/ 2

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Mark
14	P, W	a 10:35; b 35 minutes	a twenty-five to eleven; 35 minutes past 10; 10.35	a: 11:35 (hour hand read as the nearer number); a time starting with 7 (hands swapped). b: 75 (worked 3:20 minus 2:45 as 320 – 245). Time intervals across the hour may not have been taught (Grade 3).	/ 2
15	P	a $^{7}/_{10}$; b 2	a seven tenths; 0.7; 十分之七 (write L)	a: $^{3}/_{10}$ (counted the white parts) or $^{7}/_{3}$. Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	/ 2
16	P	a 18 cm; b 16 squares	b 16 cm², 16 square cm, 16	a: 16 (counted squares, not edges) or 14 (missed the edges at the step). b: Year 4 content. Perimeter and area may not have been taught (Grade 3).	/ 2
17	W	¥8 (2 marks)	8, 8 yuan, 8元	**1 mark** for 4 × 3 = 12 seen, or for ¥20 minus a wrong total worked correctly. 12 alone scores 1.	/ 2

Section A (Questions 1 to 7)	Section B (Questions 8 to 17)	Total	Of which word problems (Questions 10, 12, 14b, 17)
/ 10	/ 15	**/ 25**	/ 5

Band guide (provisional, to be reviewed after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 9 **1** Well below expected; 10 to 14 **2** Working towards; 15 to 21 **3** Expected; 22 to 25 **4** Greater depth. List the NT questions. If they explain a low score, judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Number problems and word problems. The word problems use the same skills as number problems in Section A: Question 10 (3 × 8) with Question 3, Question 12 (92 – 35) with Questions 1 and 2, Question 17 with Questions 3 and 1. A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty: check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L).

What to look for

- **Strong:** accurate written methods (column addition and subtraction, a written method for 23 × 4), working shown, sensible use of the diagrams, and answers checked against the picture.
- **A maths difficulty:** errors in Section A on taught content (Questions 1, 3 and 4) as well as in Section B; counting in ones on the grid and the bar chart.
- **An English barrier:** a strong Section A but blank or wrong word problems, or many requests to read a question; answers that come quickly once the question has been read aloud or said in Chinese.

Likely not yet taught for a student who has completed Chinese Grade 2: Questions 5 and 7 (multiplying by a one-digit number), 6 and 15 (fractions), 11 (millimetres), 14b (time intervals across the hour) and 16 (perimeter and area). Question 2 (column methods with exchanges) and Question 9 (bar charts) may also be new. Students from bilingual schools, or who have started Grade 3, may have met some of these.

5. Score summary

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	/ 8	A B C D E	
Reading paper	/ 24 (A / 8, B / 8, C / 8)	A B C D E	
Sentence reading (shared record)	points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____	indicative A B C D E	
Writing	/ 16 (task 1 / 2)	A B C D E	
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	/ 25 (A / 10, B / 15, of which word problems / 5)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:

Access arrangements (extra time, a reader, breaks):

Assessor's comments (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Student interview and suitability record: Years 3 and 4

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 8 minutes in Year 3 and 12 minutes in Year 4, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**, as a friendly chat. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, school, friends, **hopes for the future**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. In Year 3 the sentence reading is done with the Early Reading Screen; in Year 4 the interview opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 3; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Sit beside the child. Have paper and crayons ready: some children talk more easily while drawing ("Draw something you love doing, and tell me about it"). Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, a choice, or pointing). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (Year 4, 3 to 4 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___

2. Questions

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me about you.	What is your name? How old are you?	What makes you special?	
	Who is in your family?	Do you have a brother or sister? A pet?	What do you like doing with your family?	
School	Tell me about your school.	Do you like school?	What is the best thing about it?	
	What is your favourite thing to learn? Why?	Do you like maths? Reading? Art?	What did you learn last week?	
	What is hard for you at school? What do you do?	Is anything hard?	Who helps you?	
	Do you read at home? Tell me about a book you like.	Do you like stories?	What happened in it?	
Things I like	What do you like to do after school?	Do you like to play outside? Draw? Sport?	What are you best at?	
	Do you have classes after school or at the weekend?	Do you go to classes on Saturday?	Do you like them?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend? What is their name?	What do you play together?	
	What makes you happy? What makes you sad?	Are you happy today?	What do you do when you are sad?	
	How do you feel about a new school?	Happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you?	
When I grow up	What do you want to be when you grow up?	Do you want to be a teacher? A doctor? Something else?	Why?	
	What would you like to learn at our school?	Do you want to learn English? Sport? Music?		
Kindness	A child in your class is crying. What do you do?	Do you help them?	How can you help?	
Questions for us	Do you want to ask me anything?			

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best, for a child of this age.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	No English yet, or a few single words ("yes", "cat"). Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. Understands very little without pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Single words, short phrases and some simple sentences ("I like football"). Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions with support.
C Developing competence	Answers in short sentences and can say a little more with prompting ("I like football because it is fun"). Errors are common; meaning is usually clear.
D Competent	Talks easily, joins ideas, tells a little story or explains, with occasional errors. Understands nearly everything said at a normal pace.
E Fluent	Speaks as a fluent English-speaking child of the same age would.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility:

4. Suitability

Rate each strand. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning	Has a go, enjoys success, tries again after a mistake	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Interested in the activities and pictures, asks questions	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Separates from the parent and settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence	Follows two-step instructions, manages pencils and paper, can work alone for a few minutes	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Kindness and conduct	Polite, shares, gives a kind answer to the kindness question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for learning in English	Happy to try English words, copies new words, not upset by not understanding	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example speech and language, attention, hearing, vision, fine motor skills, pencil grip)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example very anxious, tired, very heavy after-school workload)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a quiet space).

Interviewer signature and date

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Paper version sat: _____ (for example v3.1; it is on the front page and in the footer of every paper)

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___). Years 7 to 10: reading paper ___ / 16 (A ___ B ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 10: fluency)	Word problems (Years 7 to 10: word questions)	Applied (Years 7 to 10)	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___	___ / 12		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**					

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 10: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 10 papers are harder, so their band boundaries are lower (guide and booklets). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. In Years 7 to 10, a student strong in fluency and word questions but weak in applied problems needs teaching in problem solving, not more content. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			